

vast sums to check the validity of the appeals. Thus, it's necessary to refuse them all.

Like almost all wealthy men—certainly, all with whom I am acquainted—I make my contributions only to organized, legitimate charities. Each and every year, my companies and I contribute sums totaling many hundreds of thousands of dollars to charity. This is the only way one can

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give money with any degree of assurance that it will be received eventually by deserving persons. I've tried to make this clear in press interviews and public statements, but without avail. Thousands of people who want me to send them money continue to write to me. "You're rich. You'll never miss the money," most of my unbidden correspondents write, as though this explains and justifies everything. Some plead. Others demand. A few even threaten. A surprisingly large number cannily specify that I'm to send them "cash—no checks" because they "don't want the tax authorities to find out about the money."

There are even those who demand the sum they request

"net—with all taxes paid."

The head of a state medical association once asked me for \$250,000—so that he could buy a yacht. "It's not much, considering what I've heard about the size of your fortune,"

he wrote. This, mind you, was a professional man—a physician who was obviously highly regarded in his community and his state. So, I presume, was the certified public accountant who used his firm's impressive stationery to request \$500,000. He'd "discovered a sure-fire system for playing the stock market"—and wanted to play it with my money. "I'll see that you get ten percent of the profits," he promised generously.

Then there was the high-school teacher who wanted a million tax-free dollars so that she could help her relatives, and the banker who wrote that he'd embezzled \$100,000